



Time for some music

Old-school speakers are no more a problem, thanks to these gadgets:
<http://dgit.in/1Fwh8os>



Power of imagination

This \$19 gizmo turned a doughnut into a keyboard. Click here to know more:
<http://dgit.in/1B9nIdp>

Laptop for around ₹50k

Dear Agent 001, I am looking forward to buying a laptop in the range of ₹50,000 or less. Could you help me with some models I can speculate on? Please help!

– Suresh Tripathy

A A price range of ₹50,000, Suresh, can get you an entire array of laptops specialising in different tasks depending on their configurations.

Let me streamline it for you. If your daily use is limited to surfing through the Internet, Microsoft Office, checking mails and watching movies, then you might not have to spend the kind of money you mentioned above, at all. For example, you can consider devices in the range of ₹30,000 to ₹35,000. The HP Compaq 15-s105TU Notebook, loaded with a 4th gen i5 processor, 4 GB RAM and 1 TB storage should be one apt option for you. Other options in this range include the Lenovo B40-70 Notebook, the HP 4430s Probook and the Dell Inspiron 15 3542 Touch Screen Laptop. However, these versions come with an Intel Core i3 instead of an Intel Core i5, which shouldn't really be a problem.

However, if you're looking for a laptop that delivered an uninterrupted gaming experience or HD video streaming, you might want to tread a little ahead in the ₹45,000-50,000 category as you will need a processor of the likes of a 4th-gen Core i5 or perhaps, even the i7.



Lenovo B40-70

But, what matters here is the graphics card. The Lenovo 2-14 Notebook, loaded with a 4th gen Core i5 and a N15V-GM graphics card should do the trick. For a laptop loaded with such awesome specs, it weighs a mere 1.9 kilograms, making it a more viable option in the price bracket. The HP Pavillion 15-p206tx Notebook and the Dell Vostro 3546 Notebook are other befitting options. So here are your options, do let us know which laptop you decided to get.

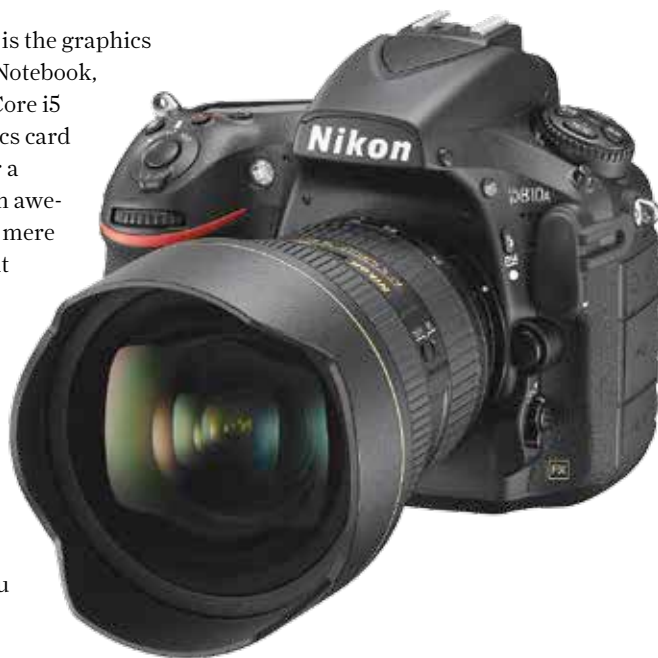
Astrophotography beckons

Dear Agent 001, I am a student who has garnered an interest in astrophotography. What kind of gadgets can I use to further enhance this interest?

– Kannankatil S

A Dear reader,

It's great to know you're interested in astrophotography. There's a lot of equipment involved and you don't want to befuddle yourselves or burn a hole in your pocket. To start with, a decent mid-range DSLR like the Canon 70D or the Nikon D7100 would fit the bill, along with a tripod. These two are a must if you want to get started. There are also specialized cameras meant only for astrophotography like the EOS 60Da from Canon and the D810A from Nikon but they are meant for experienced users. After you've learned the basics of astrophotography, you'll want to invest in an Equatorial Mount, which is used in tracking the sky's motion and is used extensively here. A good EQ mount with computerized tracking systems



The Nikon D810A was designed specifically for astrophotography

lets you navigate the stars easily and adjusts itself based on the movement of the sky. Upgrading your camera lenses, buying intervalometers and special filters is also not a bad idea. Expect to pay a total of about ₹1,50,000 for everything when beginning (Adding an EQ mount would double that price). From there, depending on how interested you are, the cost can go up by a few lakhs. I hope this answers your query. **d**

